

Eat My Body and Drink My Blood I

We have been with Noah after the flood, looking at the sacrifice he made. God changed some things and gave him a few statements with consequences.

The first thing Noah did after leaving the ark was sacrifice from the clean animals and birds, which had been brought aboard by sevens. After that sacrifice, God gave instructions concerning animals that could be eaten:

"Every moving thing that liveth
shall be meat for you."

But He also said not to eat the blood. Leviticus 17 later says to pour the blood out and cover it with dust, because the life of the flesh is in the blood and the blood makes atonement for the soul.

If the blood was eaten instead of poured out, then the atonement was not made. The blood, which was meant to represent life poured out in the place of the guilty, was consumed. In that case, the person came out from under the covering.

Under the type, as long as the blood was honored, the dread of man was on every beast. But if the blood was not atoned with, God said the life would be required.

When the Ten Commandments were given to Israel, a spiritually dead nation, God also put the Levitical priesthood in place. The priesthood was added because of transgressions until the Seed should come, Christ our Redeemer.

The priesthood sacrificed untold gallons of blood for atonement. Yet some violations carried immediate death. A man could not murder and then simply kill an animal to atone for it. Murder, adultery, and certain forms of rebellion brought death.

A rebellious son who would not receive correction, work, honor his parents, or respect God and law was brought to the elders. At the age of manhood, he could be stoned. That rebellious son was a type of the Jew who received the commandments but could not keep them. He became a type of Adam's rebellion against the Father.

Jesus stepped into the shoes of that rebellious son. He was born under the law, born of a woman, under obligation to keep the law. He could keep it because He was the first spiritually alive man born in four thousand years. He kept it morally out of a living nature. Then He became the curse of the law, hung on a tree, to redeem those under the law so they also could receive the adoption of sons.

There was a separation between sins atoned for by blood and sins that brought death. I believe the sins that brought immediate death under the law point to things that must be out of your life as you make your final journey to heaven.

You cannot live a life of adultery or perversion. You cannot rebel against God and live away from Him. The new nature is a law within itself that has freed you from those things. If you are actively destroying people while possessing the new nature, that is not a good place to be.

Better to answer now than at the judgment seat.

Under the shadow, God told Noah that the dread of man would be on the beasts. If that much authority existed under atoning blood as a type of Christ, what authority belongs to the new creation, full of the life of God and His inheritance?

Under the New Covenant, God says:

"They shall not teach every man his neighbour,
and every man his brother, saying,
Know the Lord:
for all shall know me,
from the least to the greatest."

Under the old, they had to be taught about God through ordinances, sacrifices, laws, and commandments. But to be taught about someone does not mean you know him. They did not have a nature that could know Him.

Now He has put a born-again spirit in us. He wrote His laws in our hearts and minds. That new nature becomes a law within itself, and the conscience bears witness, accusing or excusing the thoughts.

The Levitical priesthood understood the laws concerning blood. The whole nation was trained in the principle that blood was not to be eaten or drunk. So imagine Jesus standing in their midst and saying:

"Except ye eat the flesh of the Son of man,
and drink his blood,
ye have no life in you."

That is when He lost many followers. He turned to the twelve and asked, "Will ye also go away?" They answered, "Lord, to whom shall we go? Thou hast the words of eternal life."

To understand what He said, we have to follow the Born-Again Trail.

John 6:33 says:

"For the bread of God is he
which cometh down from heaven,
and giveth life unto the world."

They said, "Lord, evermore give us this bread."

Jesus answered:

"I am the bread of life:
he that cometh to me shall never hunger;
and he that believeth on me shall never thirst."

Then He said:

"All that the Father giveth me shall come to me;
and him that cometh to me
I will in no wise cast out."

People sometimes say no one can be saved unless God's Spirit draws them, then put the responsibility on God as though He is not dealing with certain people. But the passage says this is the Father's will:

"That every one which seeth the Son,
and believeth on him,
may have everlasting life."

When Jesus says no man can come except the Father draw him, He is not saying the Father randomly chooses whom to deal with. He is saying a man must respond to the Father's dealings. The Father deals with all, but unless a man yields to that drawing, the Son cannot set him free.

Knowing the Father's nature opens verses like this.

Jesus says:

"Not that any man hath seen the Father,
save he which is of God,
he hath seen the Father."

What do we do with all the preaching that Abraham, Moses, and Adam died and went straight to heaven in the same sense we do now? Jesus said no man had seen the Father. No man had seen Him until the Son revealed Him.

This also speaks to wrong ideas about baby spirits being created in heaven and sent into bodies. Human spirits come into existence through the law of Genesis God gave Adam: "Be fruitful and multiply." That is why procreation is such a serious thing. Human beings have the power to father eternal creatures.

There is nothing fair about the first birth. Children inherit the sufferings, addictions, and conditions of a fallen race. Some are born into terrible deformity or terrible cultures. The only hope is inheritance in Christ and parents who know their rights in God.

If you have children anywhere in this world, nothing God asks you to do for them is too much. Believe. Stand. Worship. Call them saved. If you can be personally involved in their salvation, do it.

When the Holy Spirit is your Teacher, even a twig of error pushed toward your spirit can cause a check. The new nature's conscience bears witness that something is wrong, even before you can explain what it is. Then the Holy Spirit teaches you why it was wrong.

But if the Holy Spirit ceases to be your Teacher, it becomes harder to hold even what you know. You can be talked out of truth. Wrong visions, wrong visitations, and wrong teachings can enter.

If a visitation tells you something against the Word, you need no more of that visitation. The Holy Spirit inoculates you against error when He is allowed to teach.

I am ordered by my conscience morally, and I am happy about it. Do I start to do wrong things? Yes. But then I get accused. I do not excuse what my new nature accuses.

If I enter into something anyway and it seems stronger than I am, then I go into transformation. I worship Him until I am stronger than it is.

This walk is getting better all the time. I do not have to wonder where I stand or whether I can do it. Religion makes a person wonder; the new nature and the Holy Spirit teach you how to walk.

John 6:48-51 says:

"I am that bread of life.
Your fathers did eat manna in the wilderness,
and are dead.
This is the bread which cometh down from heaven,
that a man may eat thereof,
and not die.
I am the living bread
which came down from heaven:
if any man eat of this bread,
he shall live for ever:
and the bread that I will give
is my flesh,
which I will give for the life of the world."

The Jews strove among themselves, asking how this Man could give them His flesh to eat.

Then Jesus said:

"Except ye eat the flesh of the Son of man,
and drink his blood,
ye have no life in you.
Whoso eateth my flesh,
and drinketh my blood,
hath eternal life;
and I will raise him up at the last day."

He says:

"He that eateth my flesh,
and drinketh my blood,
dwelleth in me,
and I in him."

Then He gives the key:

"It is the spirit that quickeneth;
the flesh profiteth nothing:
the words that I speak unto you,
they are spirit,
and they are life."

He had said to eat His flesh, then He said the flesh profits nothing. The life comes from the spirit. As He lives by the Father, the one who eats Him will live by Him and have that same life.